USER EXPERIENCE ANALYSIS

Social Media and Communication Platforms

Threads vs Bluesky

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USER EXPERIENCE

Parameters

Behavioural Design | Laws of UX | Usability Heuristics

01 Fogg's Law

Time | Money | Physical Effort | Brain Cycle | Social Deviance | Non-Routine

02 Nir Eyal's Hook Model

Trigger (Internal & External) | Action | Variable Reward | Investment

03 Laws of UX

Law of Common Region | Parkinson's Law | Serial Position Effect | Law of Proximity | Jakob's Law | Fitt's Law | Hick's Law | Aesthetic Userability Effect | Law of Similarity |Miller's Law | Zeigarnik Effect

04 Jakob Nielson's 10 Usability Heuristics

Visibility of System Status | Match Between System & Real World | User Control & Freedom | Consistency & Stds. | Error Prevention | Recognition Rather Than Recall | Flexibility & Efficiency of Use | Aesthetic & Minimalistic Design| Help Users with Errors | Help & Documentation

05 Customer Feedback Analysis

THREADS

Overview:

Threads is a microblogging platform by Meta, launched in July 2023, integrated with Instagram for easy login and follower sync. It became the fastest-growing app ever, reaching 100M users in 5 days.

Purpose:

Created as an open, community-driven alternative to X (Twitter), focusing on freedom, privacy, and decentralization rather than algorithmic control.

Features:

Text posts (up to 500 characters), 5-min videos, reposts, and replies.

Clean, simple UI with Instagram-style visuals.

No DMs or hashtags yet.

Web version and post editing added later.

No ads; monetization planned.

User Experience:

Easy onboarding via Instagram.

Familiar layout reduces learning effort

Minimal cognitive load due to fewer features

Aesthetic design enhances trust

Challenges:

Despite rapid sign-ups, user activity fell by 80% after launch. Threads is improving engagement through new features and federated (Activity-Pub) support.

Summary:

Threads offers simplicity, familiarity, and smooth usability, but struggles with long-term retention and differentiation.

BLUESKY

Overview:

Bluesky is a decentralized microblogging platform launched in 2023 by Jack Dorsey, Twitter's co-founder. It aims to give users more control and transparency over their social experience through the AT Protocol, which enables independent servers and open moderation.

Purpose:

Created as an open, community-driven alternative to X (Twitter), focusing on freedom, privacy, and decentralization rather than algorithmic control.

Features:

Text-based posts, replies, likes, and reposts.

Chronological feed (no algorithmic ranking).

Independent servers and custom moderation.

No ads or monetization yet.

User Experience:

High user control through customizable feed

Non-routine engagement due to decentralized setup

Slightly higher cognitive effort for new users to understand federation.

Challenges:

Limited user base and slower growth than Threads.	Fewer features and smaller community reduce engagement.

Summary:

Bluesky emphasizes user autonomy, openness, and decentralization, offering a transparent yet niche experience compared to Threads' mainstream approach.

Fogg's law

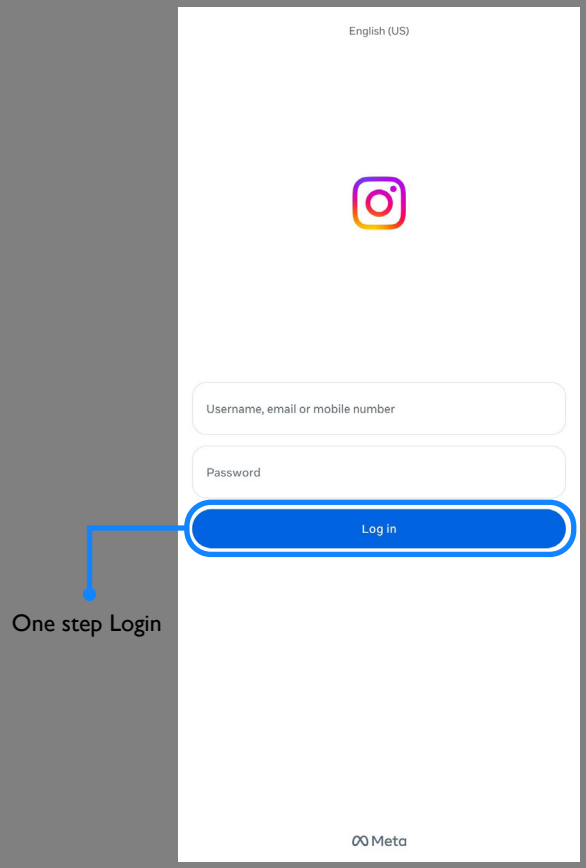
Elements of Simplicity

Fogg's Behavior Model, often referred to as Fogg's Law, provides a framework to understand why users perform or abandon actions. According to the model, a behavior occurs when motivation, ability, and triggers converge. In the context of UI/UX design, this framework helps designers identify friction points and optimize interfaces to encourage desired user actions

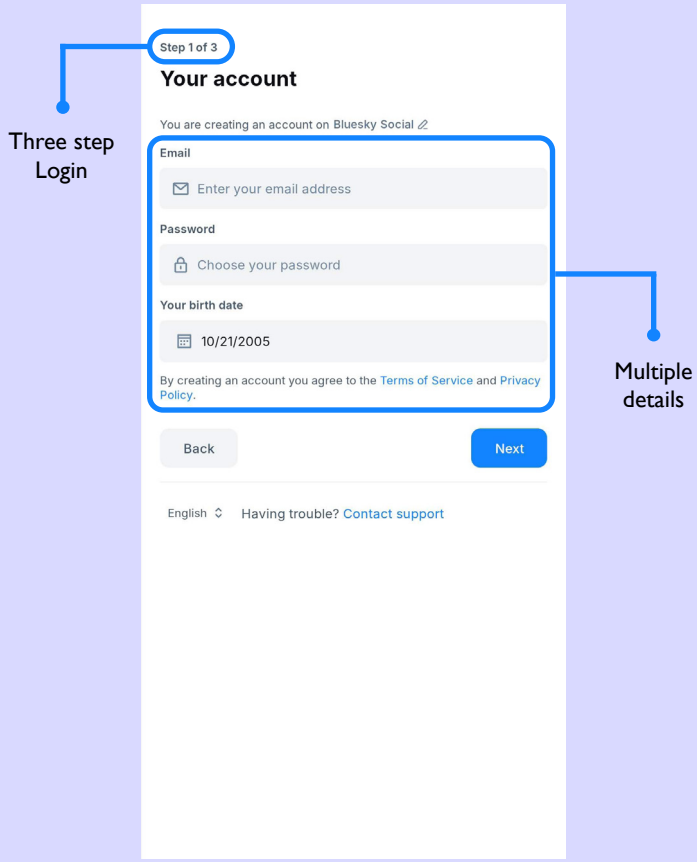
Elements of Simplicity

Fogg's law: Time

The easier and quicker an action is to perform, the more likely users are to complete it. Reducing time required for login improves user motivation and engagement.



Threads allows one-step login using the existing Instagram account. This saves time and effort by skipping new sign-ups and verification steps.



Bluesky's three-step login increases the time and cognitive load for new users, making the onboarding slower compared to Threads. Requiring multiple details (email, password, birth date) during sign-up leads to friction and delays.

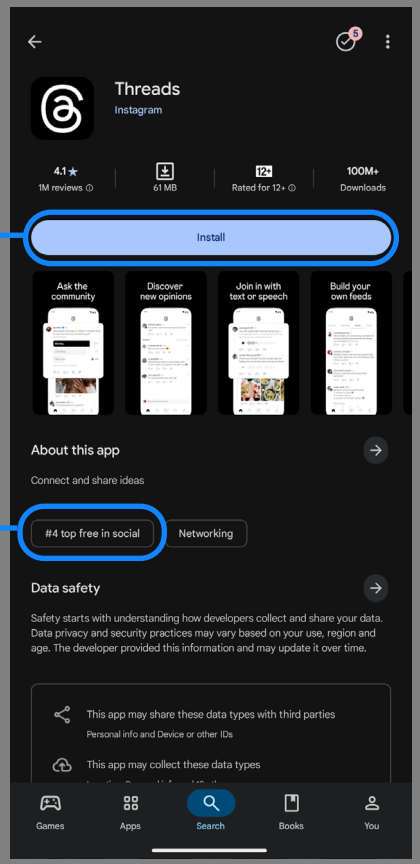
Law Applied

Elements of Simplicity

Fogg's law: Money

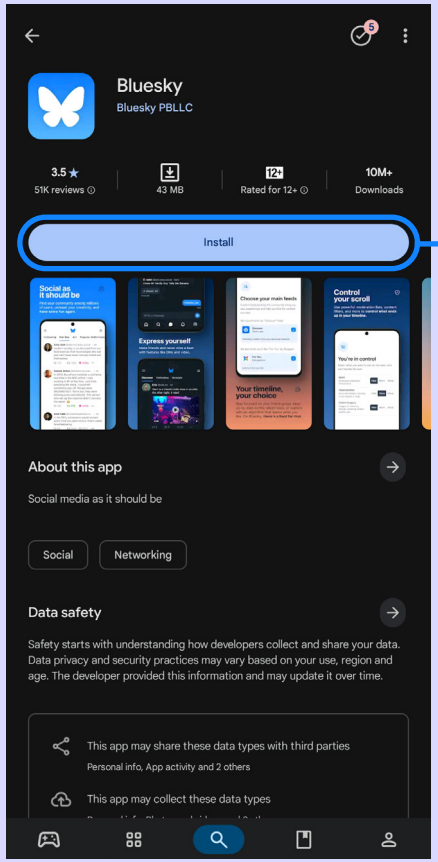
The money element refers to the financial or perceived cost of performing an action.

Users are more likely to engage when perceived value outweighs the cost, even if the cost is not monetary, but time or effort based.



Free to us

Completely free to use with no additional charges. Integrated with Instagram, it feels like an extension rather than a new paid service.



Free to use

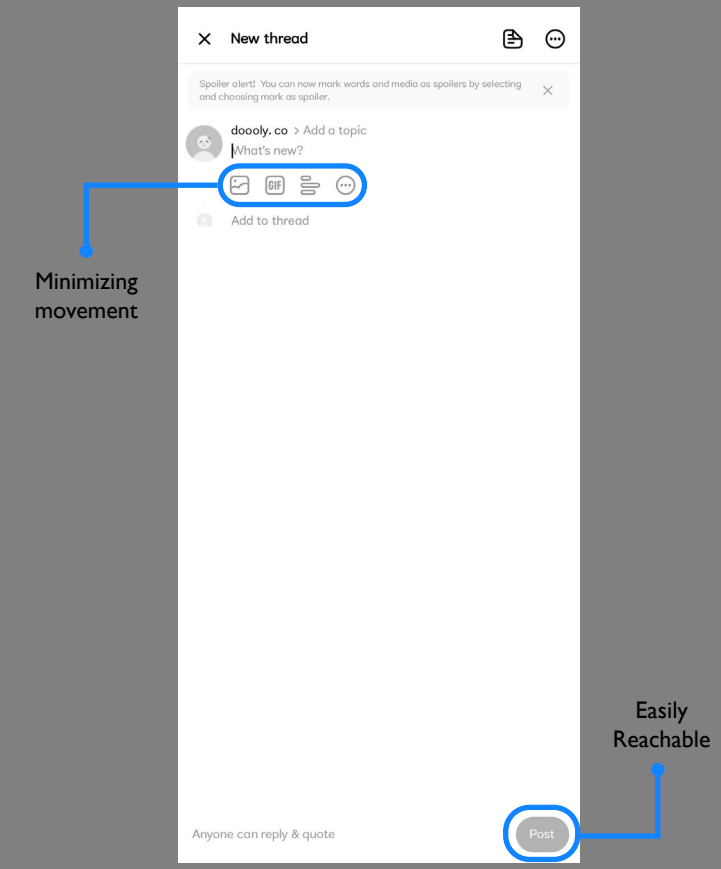
Free to use, but initially invite-only, which limited accessibility and perceived openness.

Law Applied

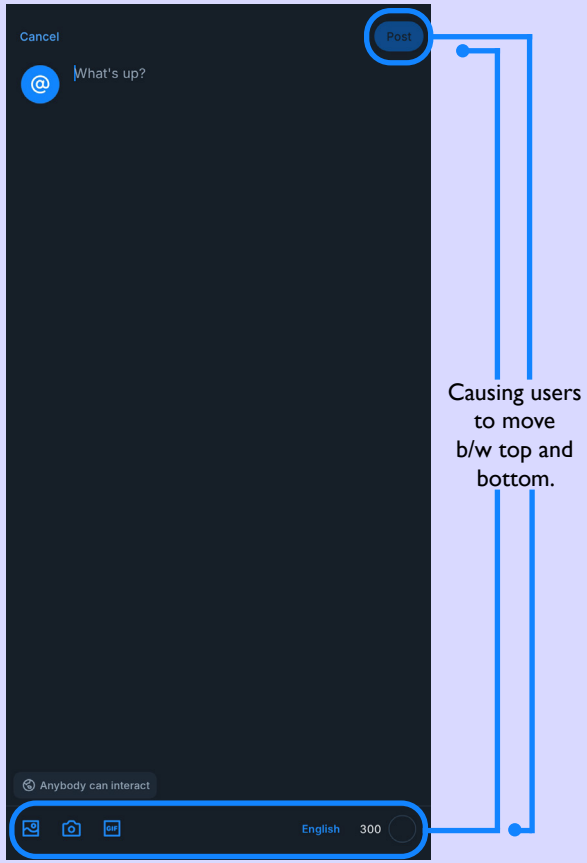
Elements of Simplicity

Fogg's law: Physical Effort

The motor effort involved, such as taps, swipes, gestures, or device handling. Lowering physical effort enhances usability



The post button is at the bottom-right, easily reachable for one-handed use. Icons for gallery, stickers, and emojis are placed just below the typing area, minimizing movement. Overall, the layout supports quick and effortless posting.



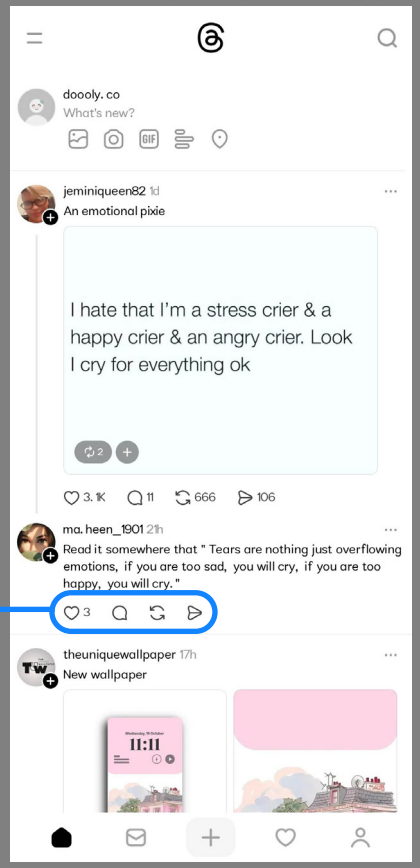
The post button at the top-right corner requires extra hand movement. Post-related buttons are at the bottom, causing users to move between top and bottom. Slightly higher physical effort compared to Threads.

Law Applied

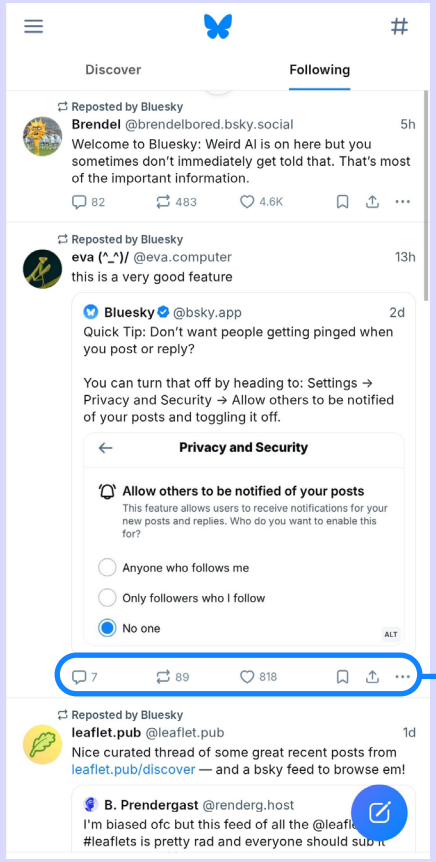
Elements of Simplicity

Fogg's law: Brain Cycle

The cognitive load required to understand and complete a task. Clear, consistent, and glanceable interfaces reduce mental effort



Threads follows Instagram's familiar design, with icons (like, comment, share) placed just below the post. The visual consistency and limited icon set make it intuitive and low in cognitive load, users instantly know what each icon does.



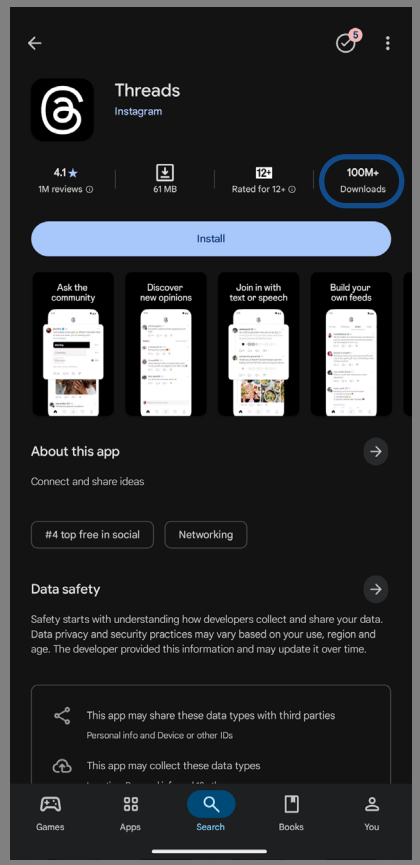
Bluesky places many icons below each post, some of which are unfamiliar or differently styled. This increases mental processing time, as users must think about what each symbol represents. The interface feels slightly cluttered, raising cognitive effort.

Law Applied

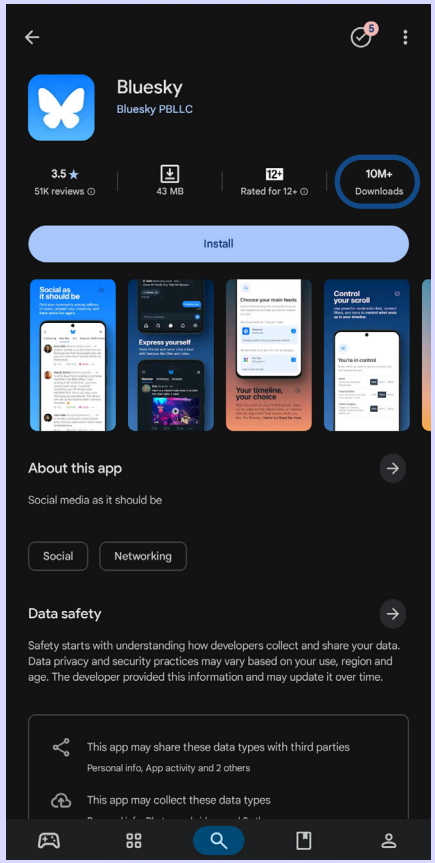
Elements of Simplicity

Fogg's law: Social Deviance

People tend to follow social norms and popular behaviors.
When many users adopt a product, others are more likely to join in.



Threads shows 100M+ downloads, reflecting massive social acceptance.Backed by Meta and connected to Instagram, it creates a sense of community and belonging, motivating more users to join.



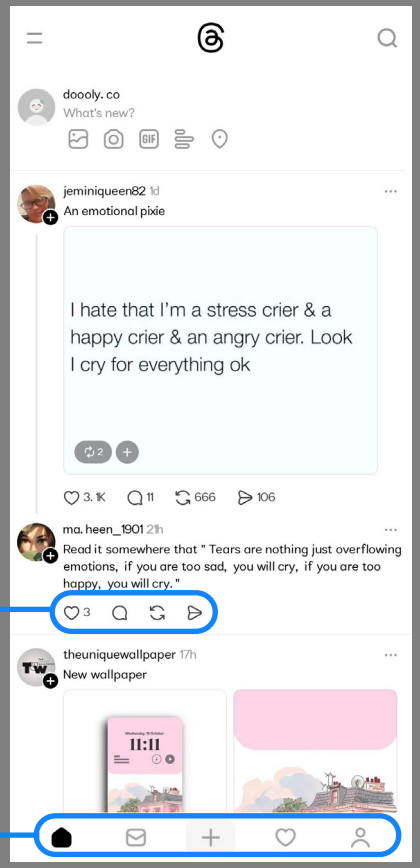
Bluesky, with around 10M+ downloads, is still niche and invite-based, giving it a smaller, exclusive audience. The lower popularity means less social proof, so fewer users feel the pull to adopt it.

Law Applied

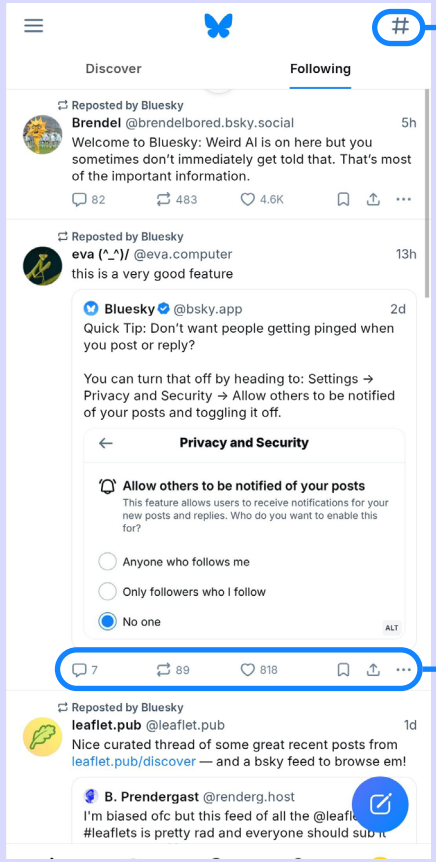
Elements of Simplicity

Fogg's law: Non-Routine

How habitual or familiar a task is. Actions that are infrequent or unfamiliar require guidance, simplification, or prompts to encourage completion



Threads' feed layout and interactions are similar to Instagram, making it instantly familiar and easy to navigate for existing users.This reduces learning effort and encourages quick adoption.



Bluesky's feed feels new and different, with unfamiliar icons and layout.Users may take longer to understand and adapt, creating a small barrier to engagement.

Law Applied

NIR EYAL'S HOOK MODEL

Habit-forming / Behavioural Design

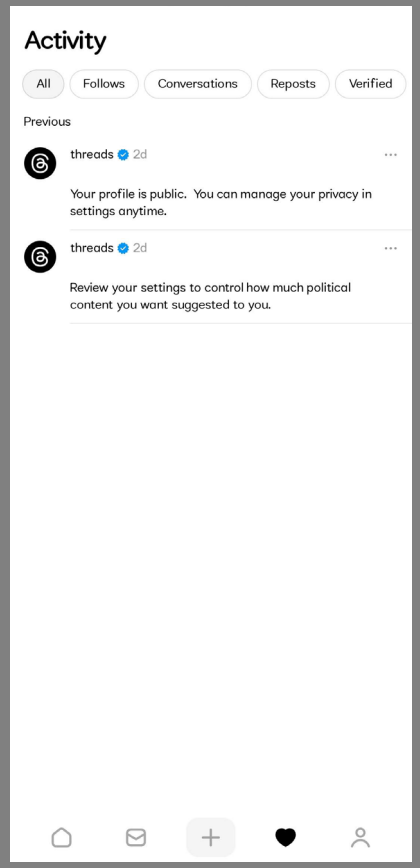
The Hook Model, developed by Nir Eyal, a behavioural economist, in UI/UX design explains how products form user habits by creating a loop that drives repeated engagement. It consists of four key stages that connect users' problems with your solution, encouraging long-term use and loyalty

Habit-forming / Behavioural Design

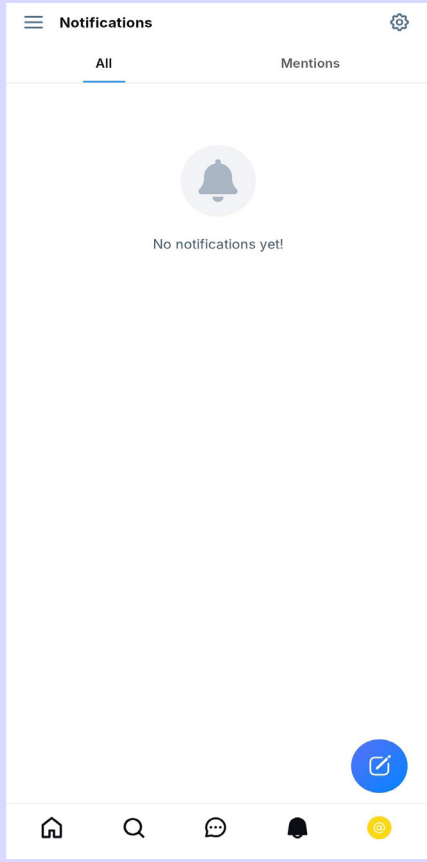
Hook's model: Trigger

(Internal)

An internal trigger comes from within the user. Emotions like boredom, curiosity, or the fear of missing out (FOMO) that push them to open the app.



The Activity tab shows likes, follows, and replies, triggering curiosity and social validation.
Users return to check who interacted, building an emotional habit loop.



The Notification tab also shows replies and mentions but with less visual emphasis and fewer interactions. This creates a weaker emotional pull compared to Threads.

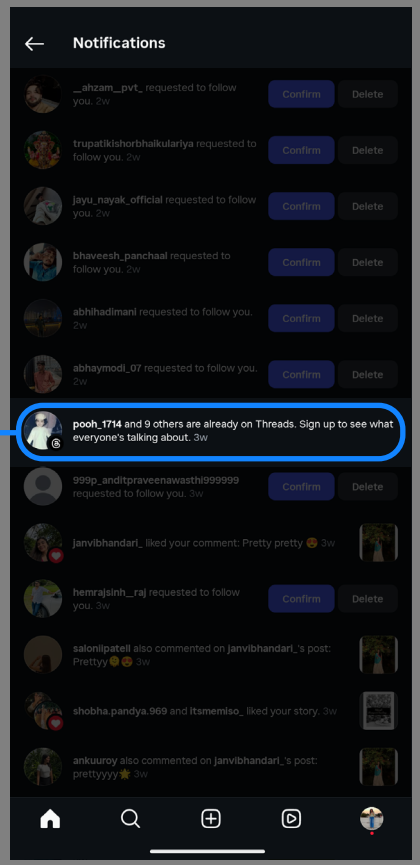
Law Applied

Habit-forming / Behavioural Design

Hook's model: Trigger

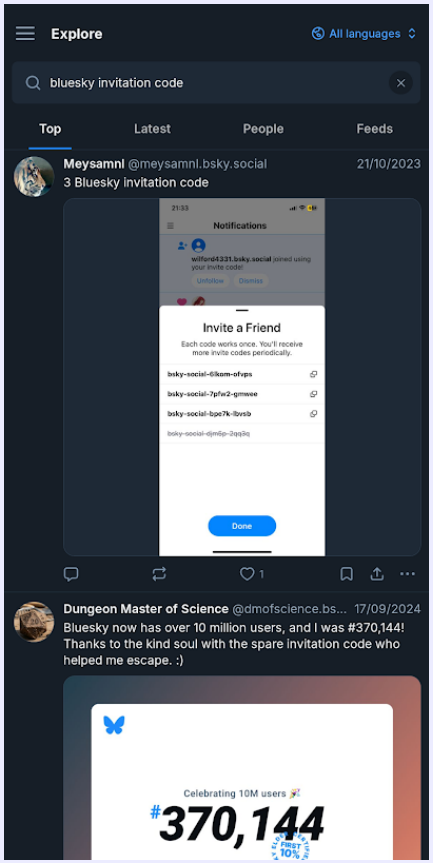
(External)

External triggers include Instagram prompts, in-app notifications, and cross-platform updates.



in-app notifications

External triggers include Instagram prompts, in-app notifications, and cross-platform updates.
Users are nudged through Instagram and notifications to open and engage with Threads.



The invite system acts as a powerful external trigger. Users receive invites from friends or community members, prompting them to join and engage.

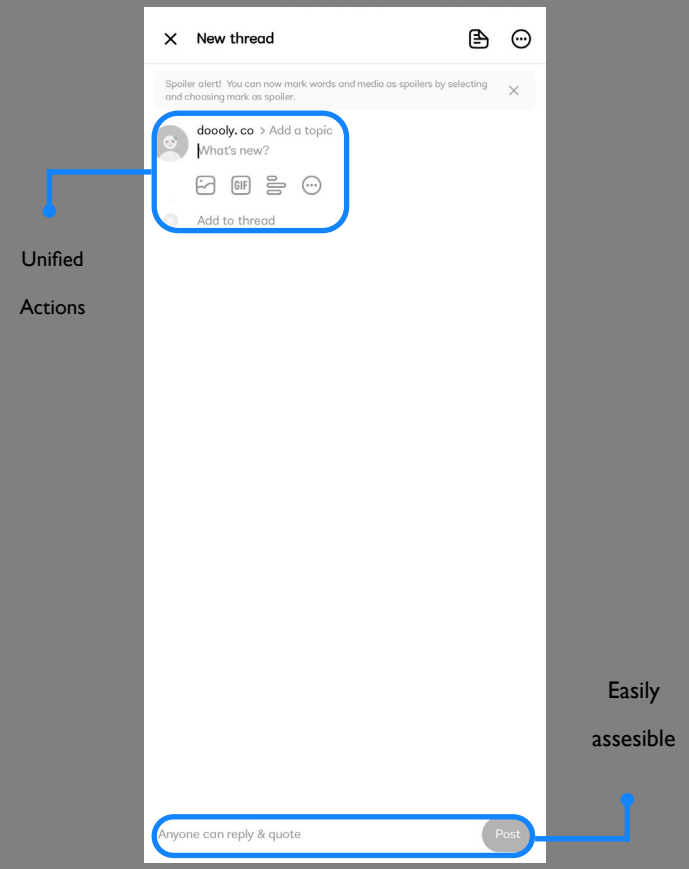
Law Applied

Habit-forming / Behavioural Design

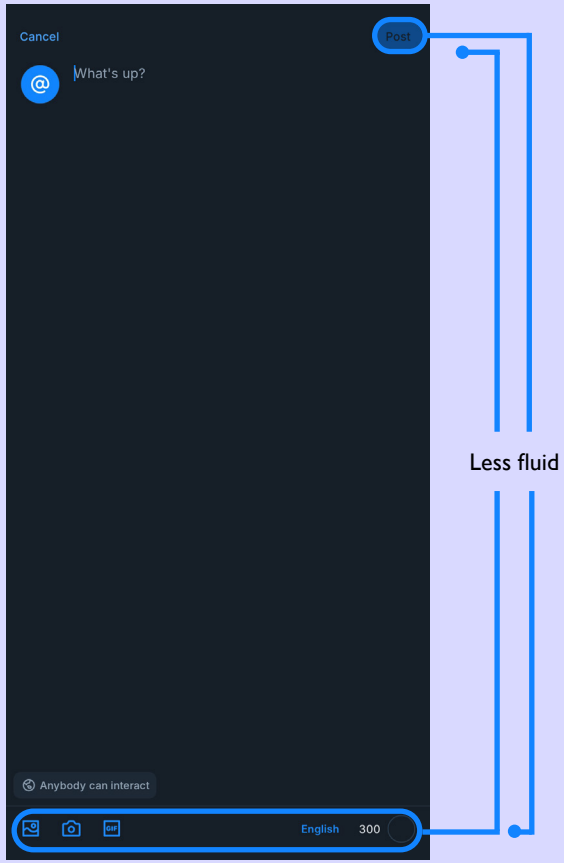
Hook's model: Action

The simplest behavior performed in anticipation of a reward,

e.g., clicking, scrolling, or liking



Threads promotes quick actions with an easily accessible post button and a familiar interface. Users can instantly scroll, like, or post, reducing friction and increasing engagement.



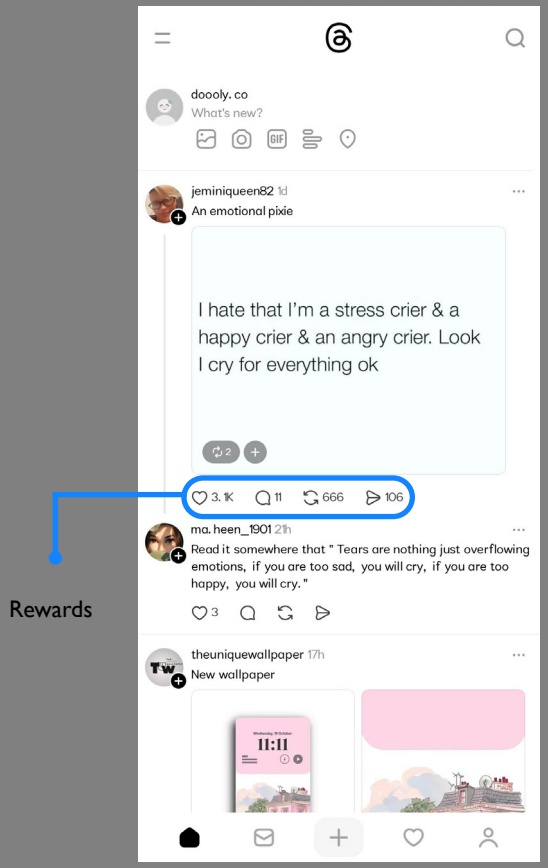
Bluesky requires slightly more effort as the post button is at the top.The interface feels less familiar, making actions like posting or replying less fluid.

Law Applied

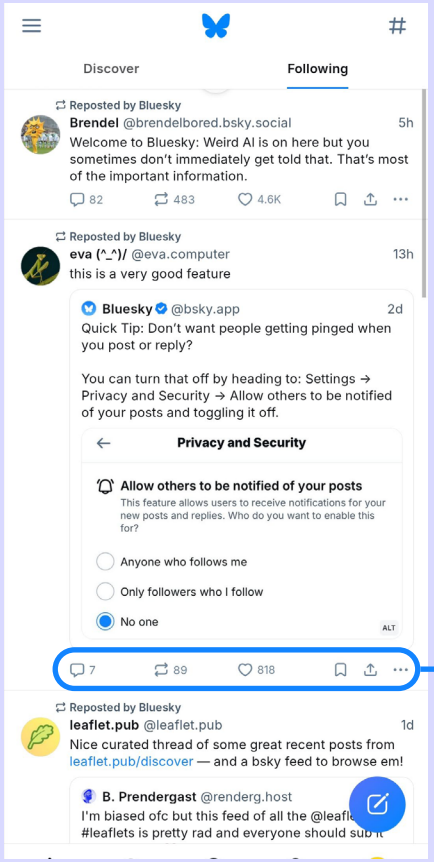
Habit-forming / Behavioural Design

Hook's model: Variable Reward

Users receive unpredictable or varied rewards that satisfy curiosity and encourage repeated use.



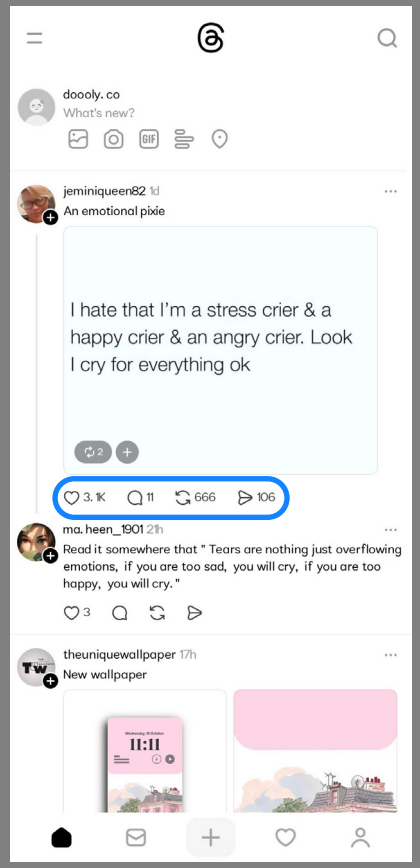
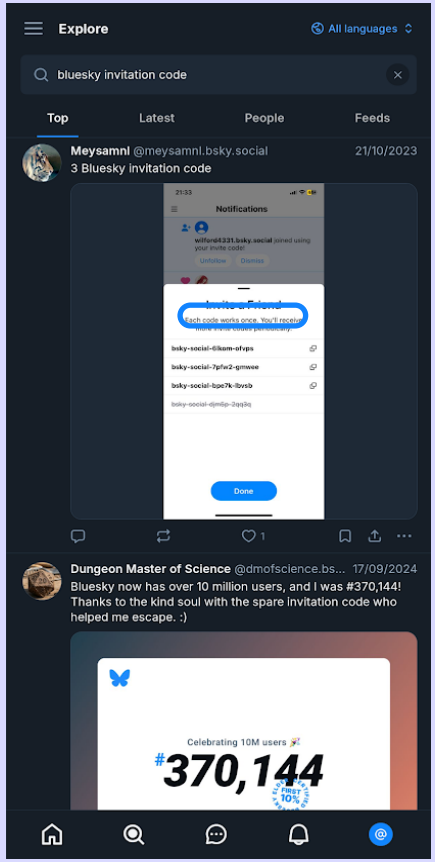
Threads offers a mix of familiar and trending content, creating a sense of novelty. The unpredictable feed, filled with replies, memes, and trending posts, keeps users scrolling for new surprises.



Bluesky's feed also provides varied posts from different communities, but the content discovery is slower. Limited algorithmic curation reduces the "reward loop" effect compared to Threads.

Law Applied

Habit-forming / Behavioural Design

Hook's model: Investment		
The effort users put in (time, data, customization) that increases their likelihood of returning	 Threads encourages investment by letting users build a personal profile and connect Instagram followers easily. The time spent posting, replying, and curating their feed strengthens emotional attachment and return intent.	 Bluesky users invest effort by setting up decentralized handles and connecting through invite-based access.
Law Applied	✓	✓

LAWS OF UX

Principles of Human-Compter Interaction

The Laws of UX are psychological principles that guide designers in creating intuitive, user-friendly, and engaging interfaces. They explain how users perceive, process, and interact with digital products, helping designers make informed layout, navigation, and interaction decisions that align with human behavior.

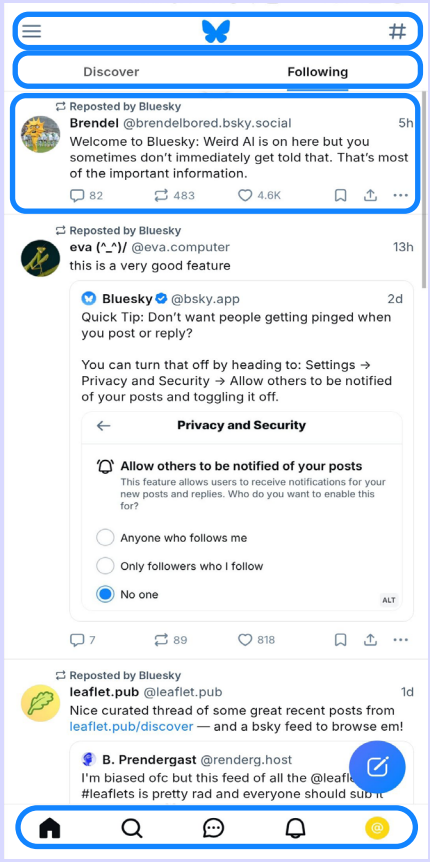
Principles of Human-Compter Interaction

Laws of UX: Law of Common Region

Elements enclosed within the same area are perceived as related, improving group clarity and visual hierarchy



In Threads, each post is visually separated with clear spacing and boundaries. User info, post content, and interactions are grouped together, making it easy to identify related elements.



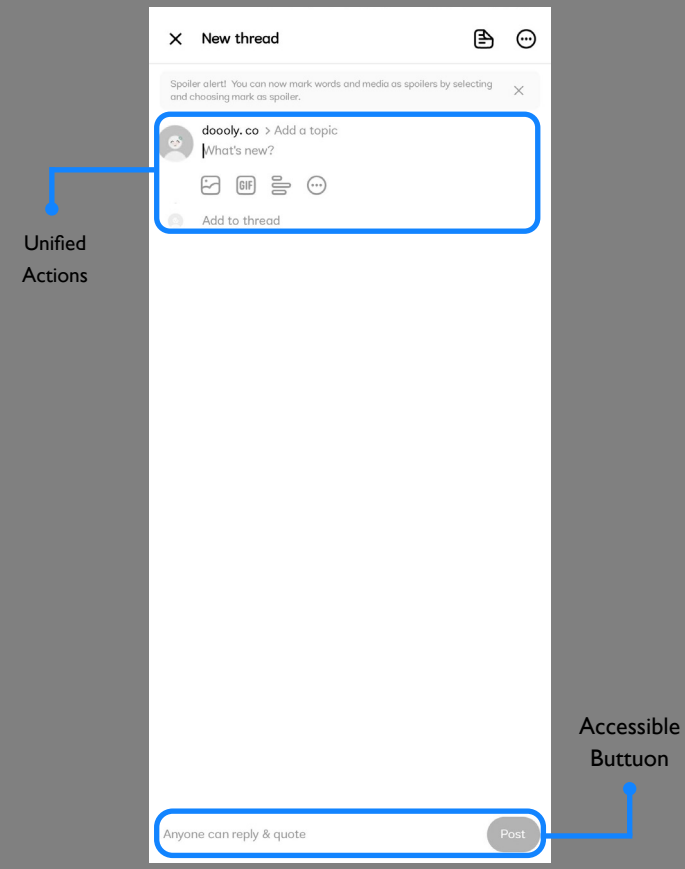
Bluesky also uses boxed regions for posts, but spacing and visual separation is more of a cluter .

Law Applied

Principles of Human-Compter Interaction

Laws of UX: Parkinson's law

Tasks expand to fill the time available interfaces should promote efficiency and minimize unnecessary steps



Threads minimizes effort with a clean, fast posting flow. The simple layout ensures users spend less time completing actions like posting or replying.



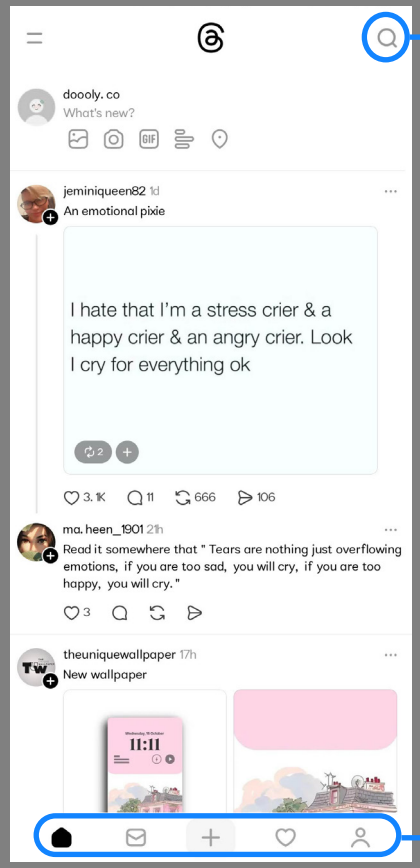
Bluesky's posting layout is slightly more complex, with options placed separately.This increases the time taken for users to perform simple actions.

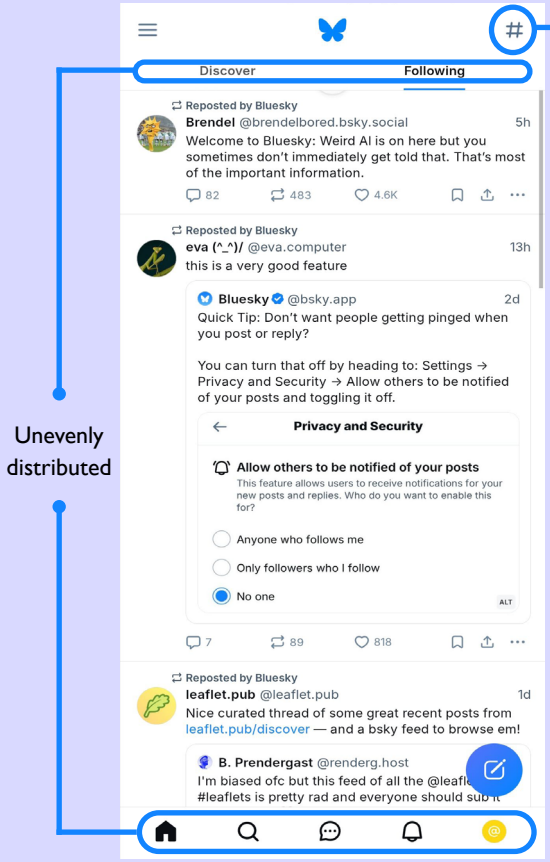
Law Applied

Principles of Human-Compter Interaction

Laws of UX: Serial Position Effect

Users best remember the first and last items in a series; key actions should appear at these positions





Threads places important icons like Home (first) and Profile (last) aligning with natural recall patterns. This helps users easily find and remember key navigation points.

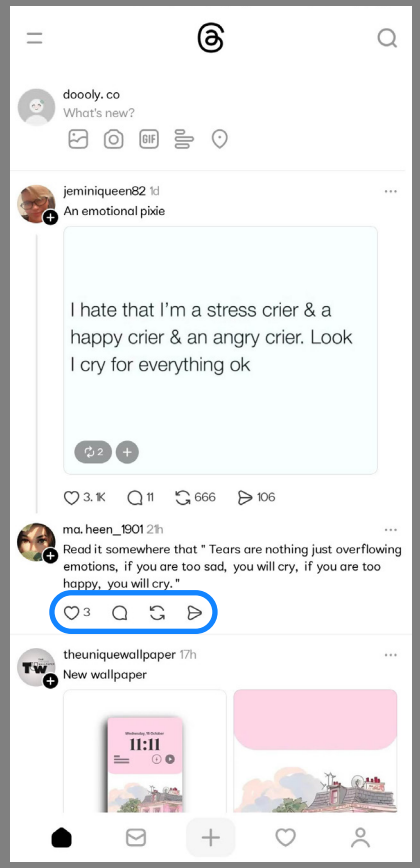
Bluesky follows a similar layout, but icon design and spacing make recall slightly slower. The icons are unevenly distributed without emphasizing start or end positions.

Law Applied

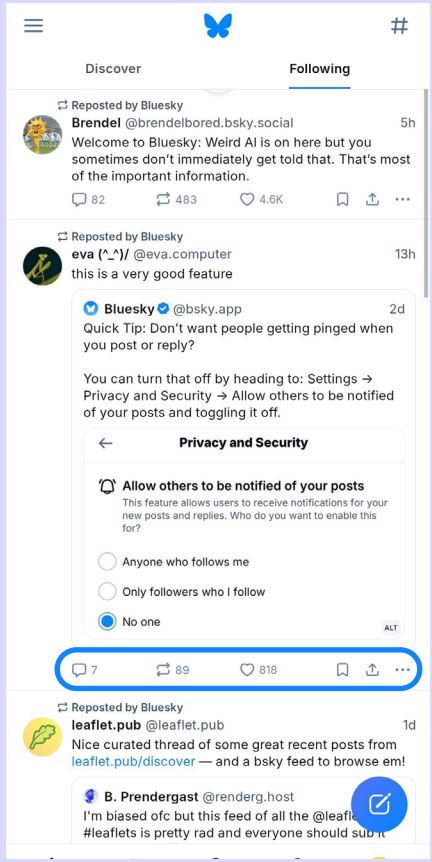
Principles of Human-Compter Interaction

Laws of UX: Law of Proximity

Objects placed close together are seen as a group, guiding users to associate related functions



Related elements like likes, replies, and share icons are placed close to each other. This makes interactions intuitive and visually organized.



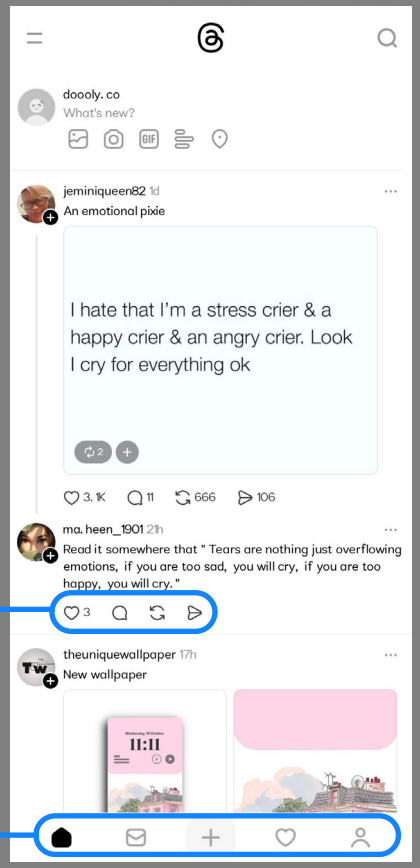
Bluesky also groups related icons under each post, but the spacing is slightly wider. It maintains clarity but feels less compact than Threads.

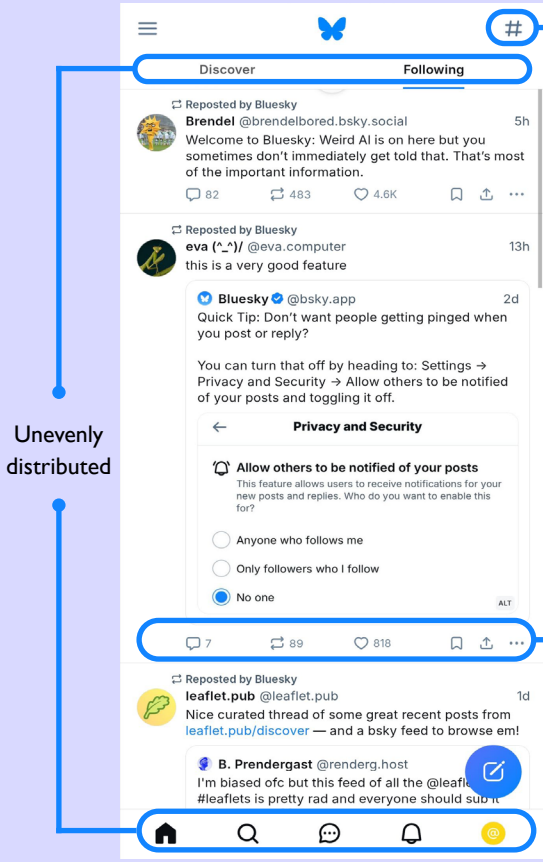
Law Applied

Principles of Human-Compter Interaction

Laws of UX: Jakon's Law

Users prefer designs that feel familiar ,following conventions from other products reduces the learning curve.



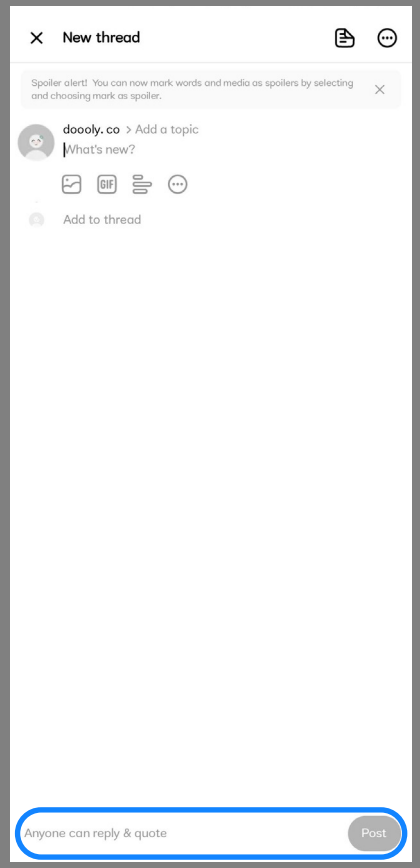
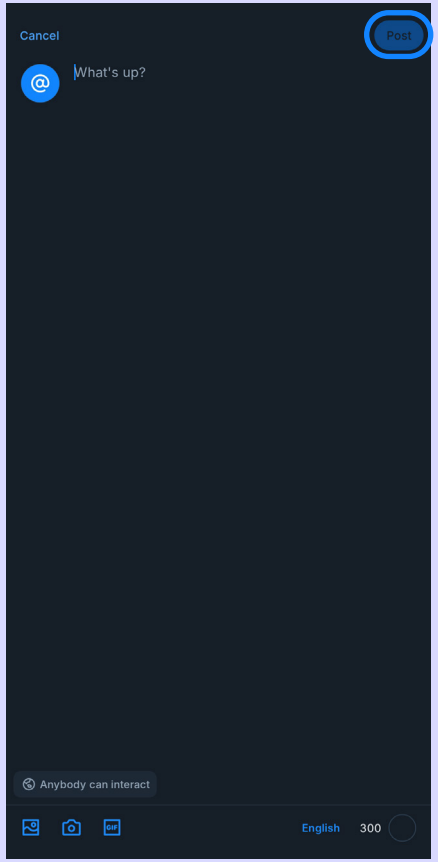


Threads follows familiar design patterns from Instagram similar icons, feed layout, and interaction style. This reduces the learning curve and makes navigation effortless for existing Meta users.

Users may take extra time to understand interactions and navigation because of the uneven distribution of functions across the interface.

Law Applied

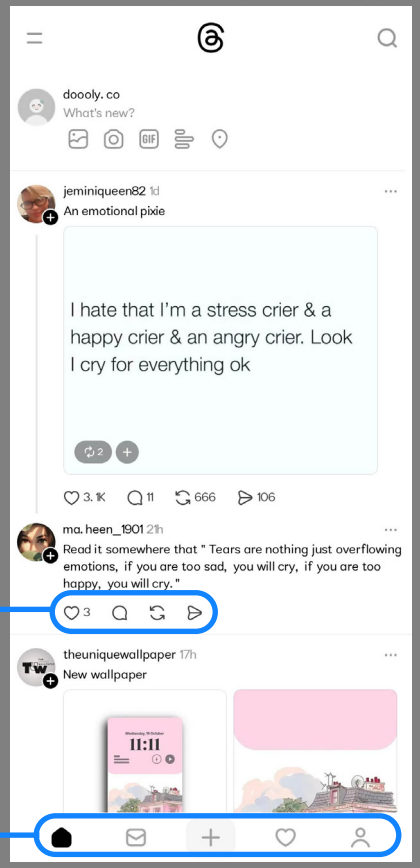
Principles of Human-Compter Interaction

Laws of UX: Fitt's Law		
The time to reach a target depends on its size and distance.		
	Threads places the post button at the bottom-right, large and easily reachable with the thumb. This placement follows ergonomic design, reducing movement time and improving accessibility.	Bluesky's post button is placed at the top right, requiring more hand movement. Though visible, it's less thumb-friendly and slightly slower to access on larger screens.
Law Applied	✓	✗

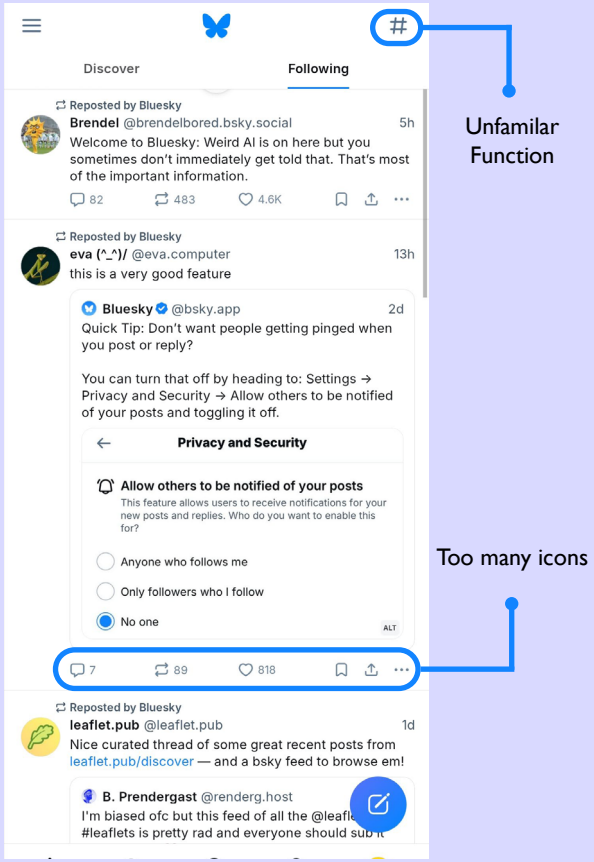
Principles of Human-Compter Interaction

Laws of UX: Hick's Law

The more choices a user has, the longer it takes to decide, simplify menus and options for faster decisions.



Threads' feed layout and interactions are similar to Instagram, making it instantly familiar and easy to navigate for existing users.This reduces learning effort and encourages quick adoption.



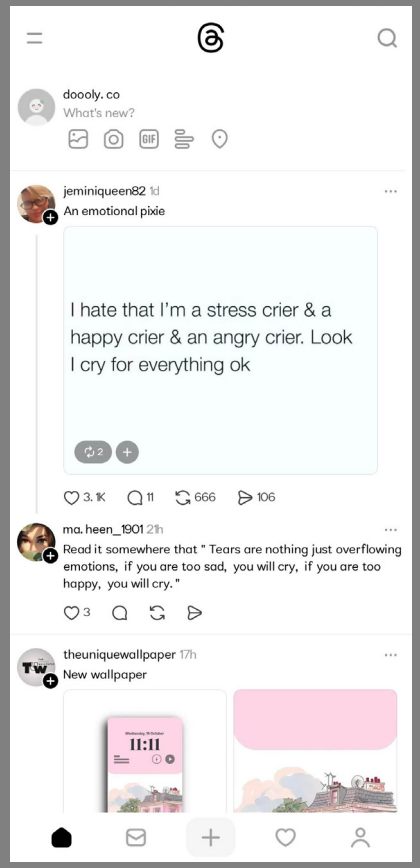
Bluesky's feed feels new and different, with unfamiliar icons and layout.Users may take longer to understand and adapt, creating a small barrier to engagement.

Law Applied

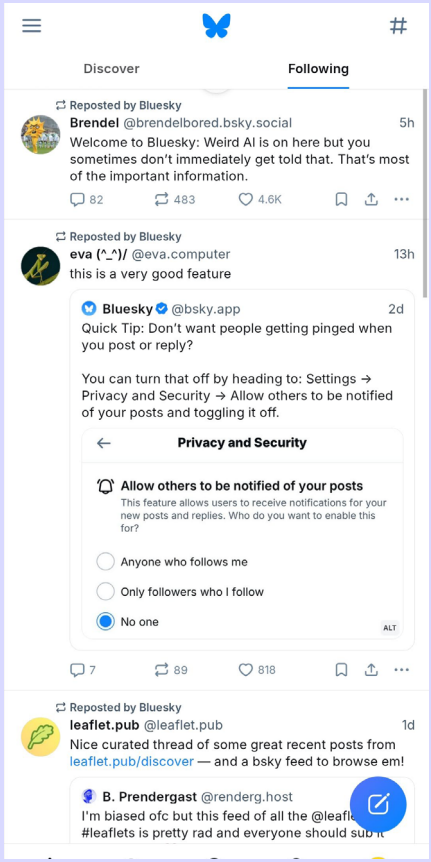
Principles of Human-Compter Interaction

Laws of UX: Aesthetic Usability Effect

Users perceive attractive interfaces as easier to use, even if functionality is identical



Threads uses a clean, minimal design with balanced spacing and familiar icons. The visually pleasing interface enhances perceived ease of use and comfort.



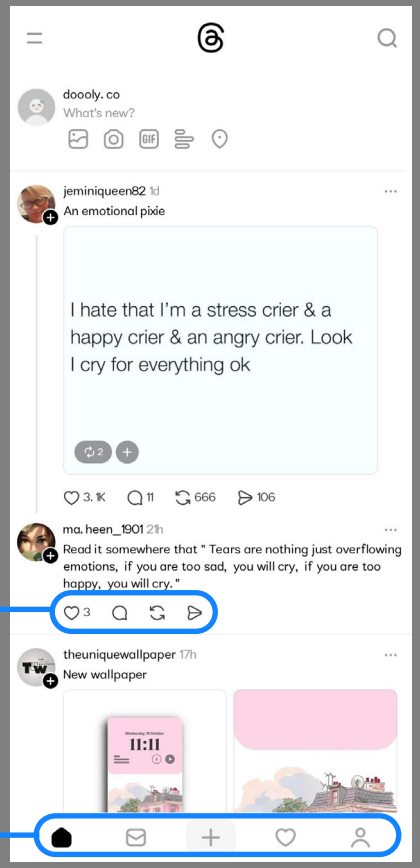
Bluesky offers a straightforward but less polished interface with tighter spacing and heavier text density. While functional, it feels less visually refined than Threads.

Law Applied

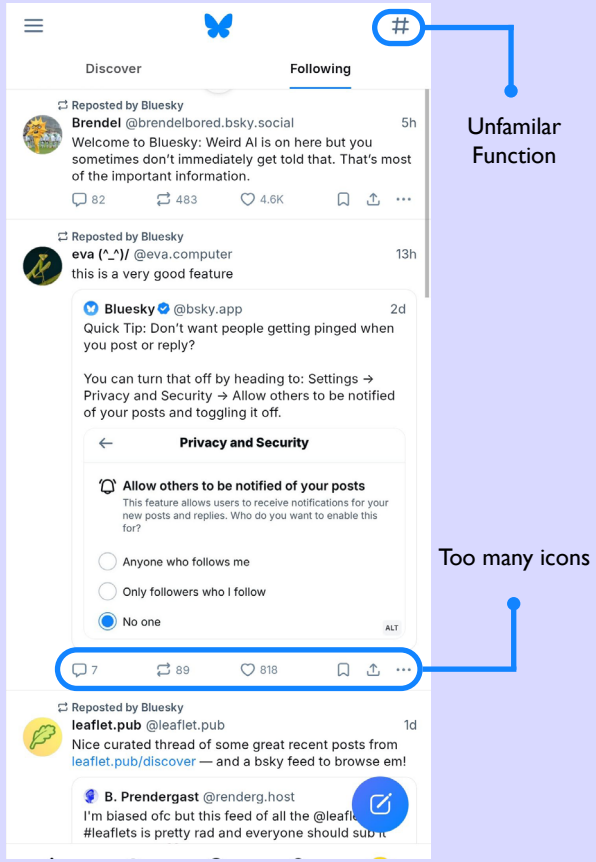
Principles of Human-Compter Interaction

Laws of UX: Law of Similarity

Visually similar elements are seen as related, consistent colors and styles help users predict function.



Threads maintains visual consistenc, icons for likes, comments, and shares share similar shapes and colors. This helps users quickly recognize and relate functions.



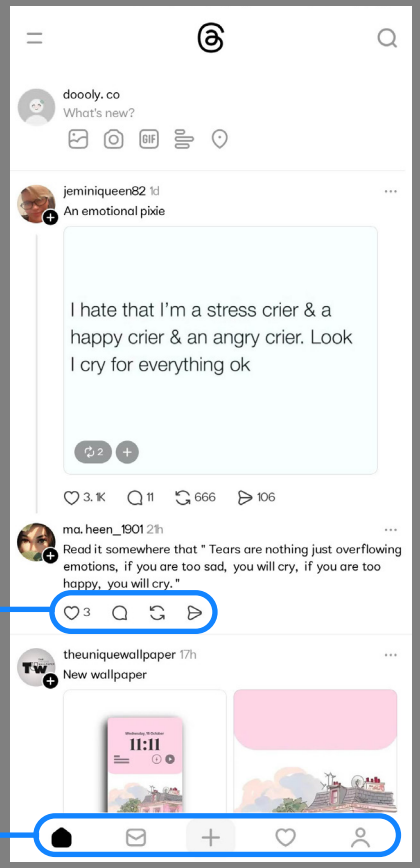
Bluesky also uses similar-looking icons for related actions, but spacing and size vary slightly.The overall uniformity still helps users identify related functions easily.

Law Applied

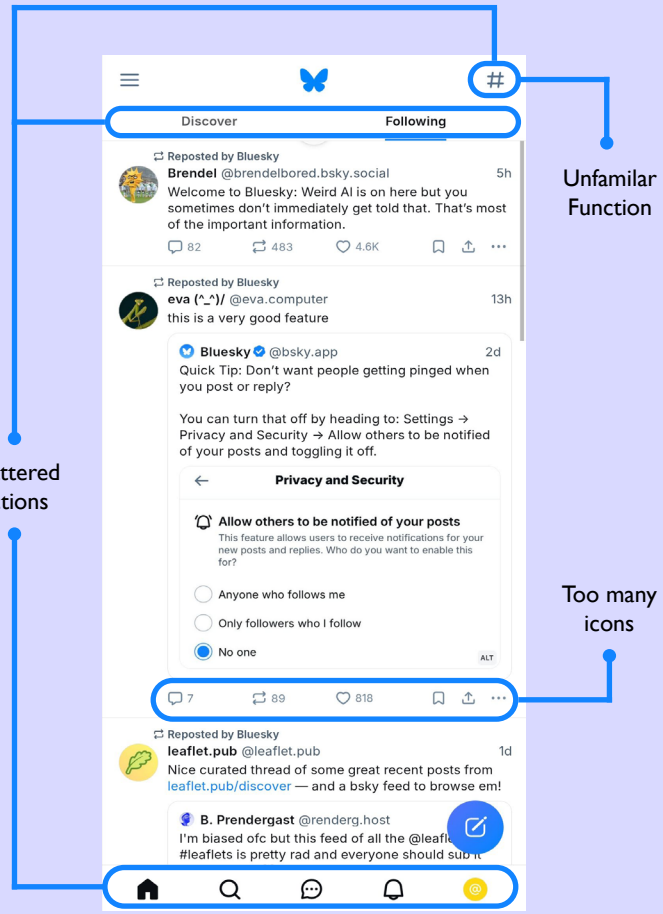
Principles of Human-Compter Interaction

Laws of UX: Miller's Law

People can hold about 7±2 items in working memory, limit visible options or chunk information logically



Threads keeps its interface simple with limited visible options, Home, Search, Post, Activity, Profile. The minimal layout prevents cognitive overload and supports easy navigation.



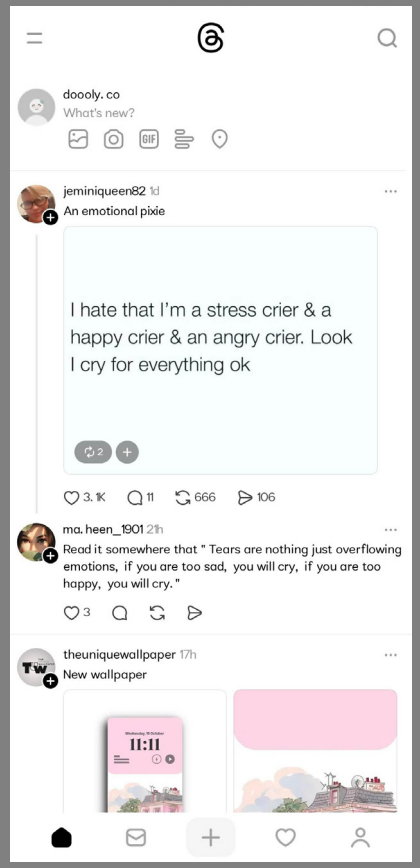
Bluesky includes more visible options and detailed menus, which can slightly increase cognitive load. However, the overall structure remains manageable once users get familiar.

Law Applied

Principles of Human-Compter Interaction

Laws of UX: Zeigarnik Effect

People remember unfinished tasks better than completed ones, progress bars or reminders motivate task completion.



Threads does not display visible indicators of incomplete tasks. The interface focuses on continuous scrolling rather than prompting task completion.



Bluesky clearly applies this law by showing a circular progress ring during setup, urging users to follow 10 accounts. This visual cue of an incomplete task encourages users to engage until the goal is completed.

Law Applied

10 USABILITY HEURISTICS

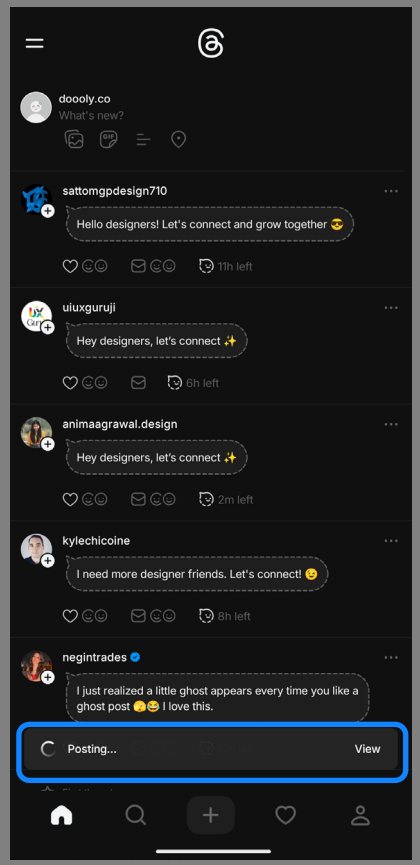
By Jakob Nielsen

Jakob Nielsen's 10 Usability Heuristics are foundational principles in UI/UX design that help evaluate how userfriendly, intuitive, and efficient an interface is. They are not strict rules but general guidelines to design digital products that feel natural, error-free, and easy to navigate

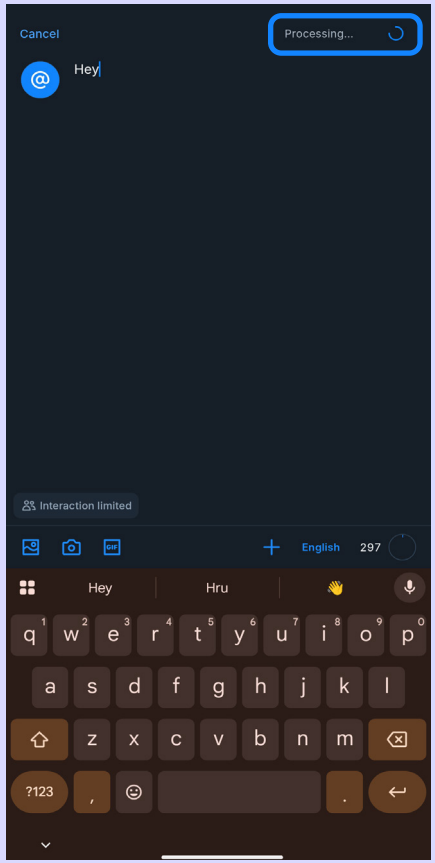
Visibility of System Status

Usability Heuristics: Feedback

The system should always keep users informed about what's happening through appropriate visual or textual feedback (e.g., progress bars, notifications)



When a post is being uploaded, Threads shows a clear "Posting…" indicator at the center-bottom of the screen, making the progress easily noticeable.



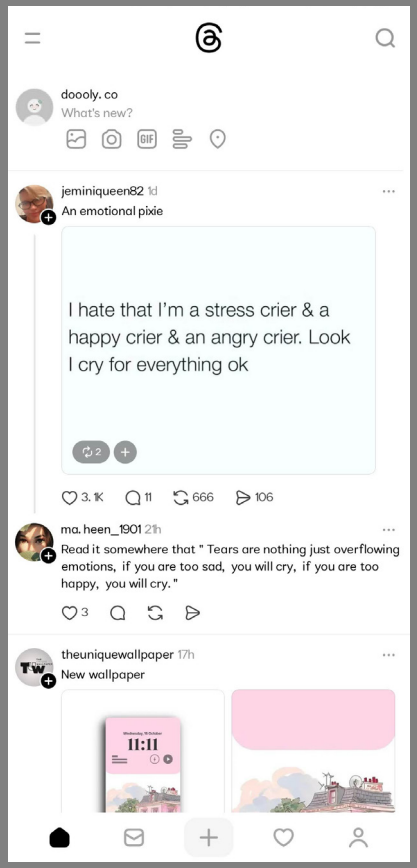
In Bluesky, the "Posting…" indicator appears at the top-right corner, making it less visible

Law Applied

Match between system & real world

Usability Heuristics: Realism

The system should speak the users' language, using familiar concepts, visuals, and interactions that feel natural.



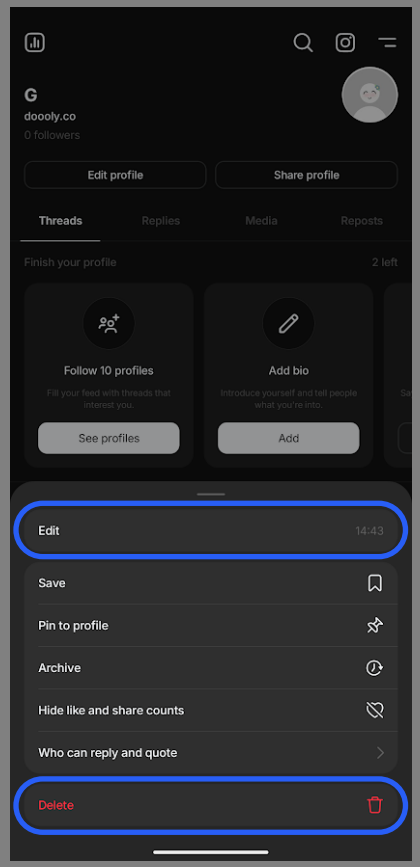
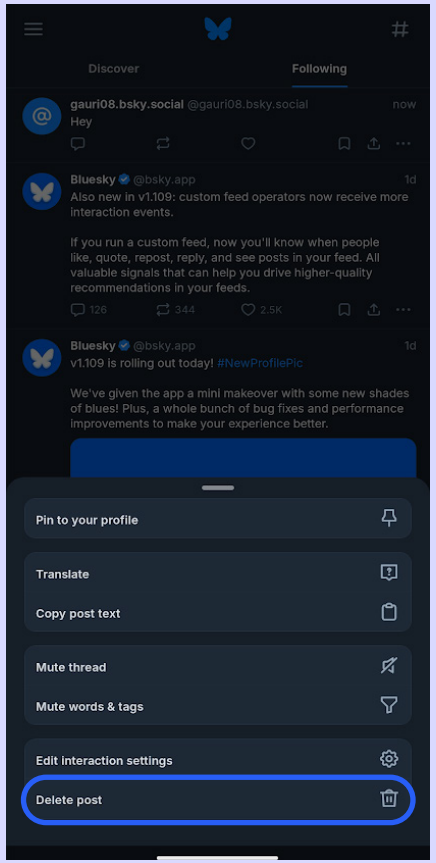
Threads mirrors Instagram's interface and visual hierarchy, using familiar icons, layouts, and post formats.



Bluesky's interface and icons differ from typical social apps, with less familiar placements and labels.

Law Applied

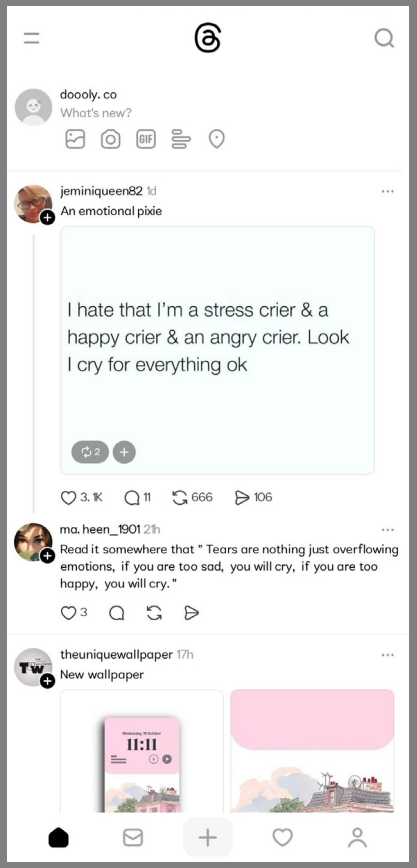
User Control & Freedom

Usability Heuristics: Undo/ Redo		
Users should have the freedom to undo actions, navigate easily, and not feel trapped by the system.		
	Threads allows users to edit posts, delete threads, and navigate back easily.However, account integration with Instagram slightly limits control over account-level settings.	Bluesky allows users to delete posts and customize feeds. However, it lacks an edit feature and has fewer intuitive navigation options.
Law Applied	✓	✓

Consistency & Standards

Usability Heuristics: Uniformity

Users should not have to wonder whether different words, actions, or situations mean the same thing. The interface should follow platform conventions.



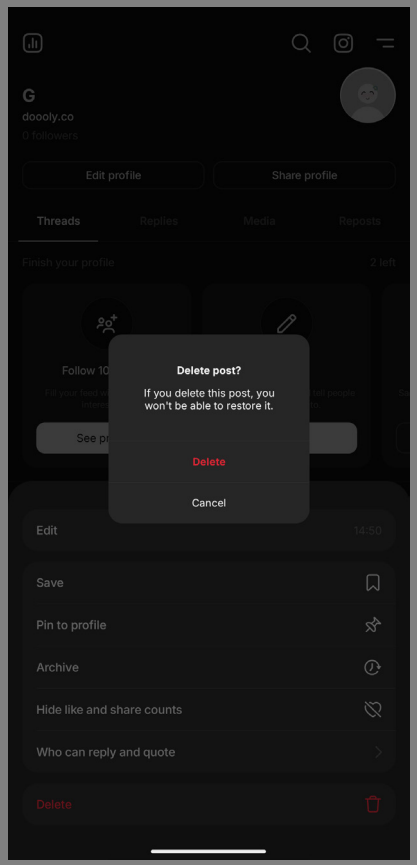
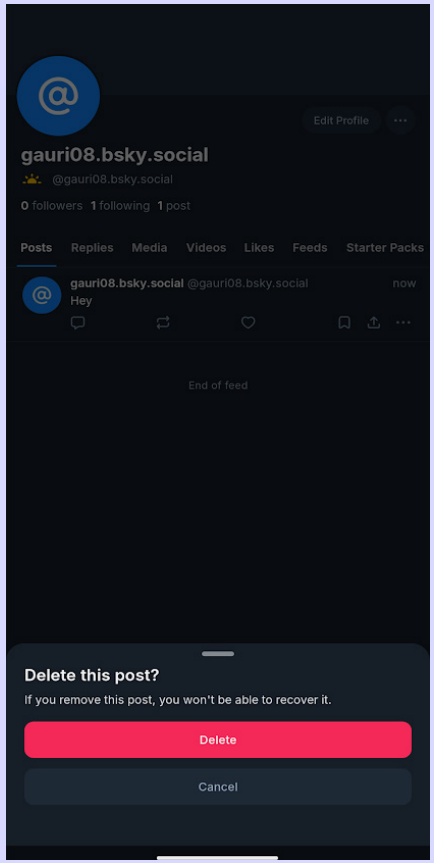
Threads maintains consistent design and iconography similar to Instagram, same icons for likes, comments, and sharing.



Bluesky introduces new icons and layouts that differ from other social media apps, which may initially confuse users.

Law Applied

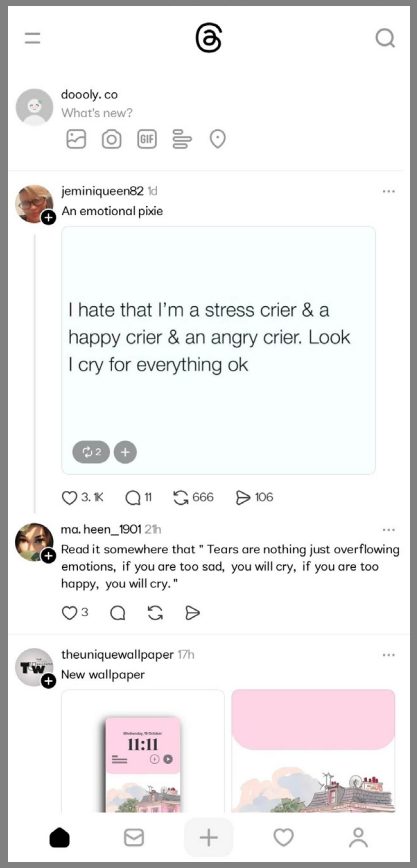
Error Prevention

Usability Heuristics: Prevention		
The design should prevent problems from occurring by guiding users and confirming critical actions before they happen.		
	Threads prompts confirmation before deleting a post or leaving the composer without posting.	Bluesky also prompts confirmation before deleting a post
Law Applied	✓	✓

Recognition Rather than Recall

Usability Heuristics: Recognition

Interfaces should minimize the user's memory load by making options, actions, and information visible, users should recognize choices instead of remembering them.



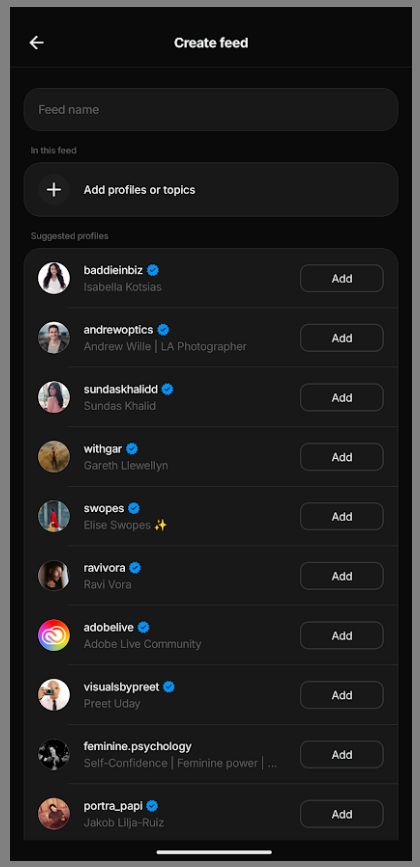
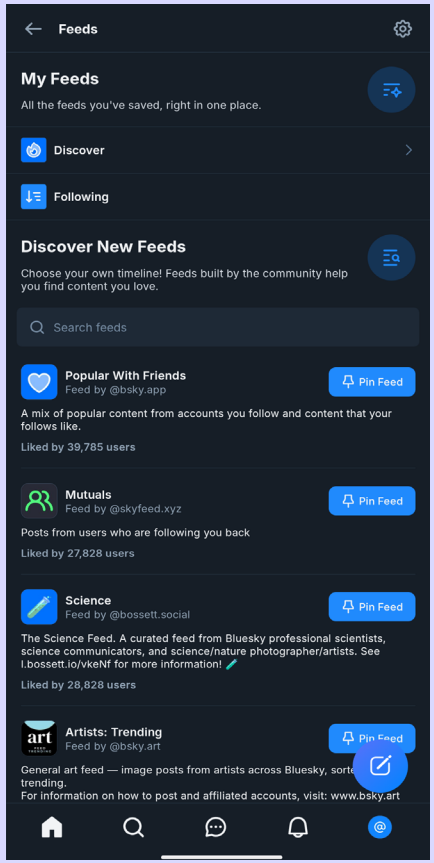
Threads uses familiar Instagram-like icons and clearly visible options for posting, liking, and sharing.



Bluesky introduces new icons and placements that users must learn through exploration.

Law Applied

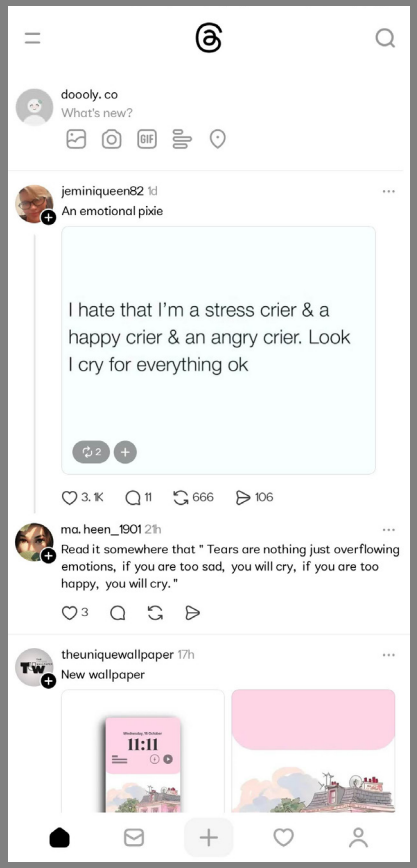
Flexibility & Efficiency of Use

Usability Heuristics: Shortcuts		
The interface should cater to both new and experienced users, allowing shortcuts and customization to speed up interactions.		
	Threads integrates seamlessly with Instagram, allowing users to import followers and cross-share posts. Simple navigation supports both beginners and frequent users.	Bluesky offers features like custom feeds and content filters, giving flexibility to advanced users. However, new users may find these features less intuitive at first.
Law Applied	✓	✓

Aesthetic & Minimalist Design

Usability Heuristics: Simplicity

Interfaces should not contain irrelevant information. Every extra element competes with relevant content and reduces clarity.



Threads follows a minimal, clean layout with a white background and simple typography. Focus remains on the content, similar to Instagram's visual clarity.



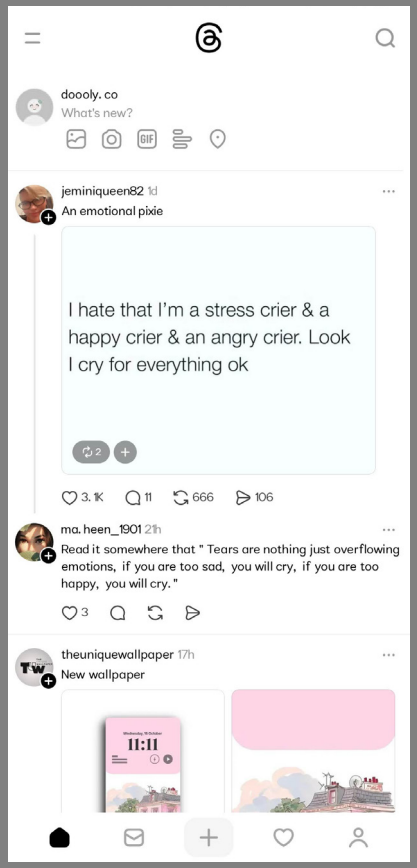
Bluesky uses a slightly denser interface with multiple icons and controls visible at once. The layout can appear busier to new users.

Law Applied

Help Users with Errors

Usability Heuristics: Recovery

The system should clearly indicate when an error occurs and guide the user to fix it easily.



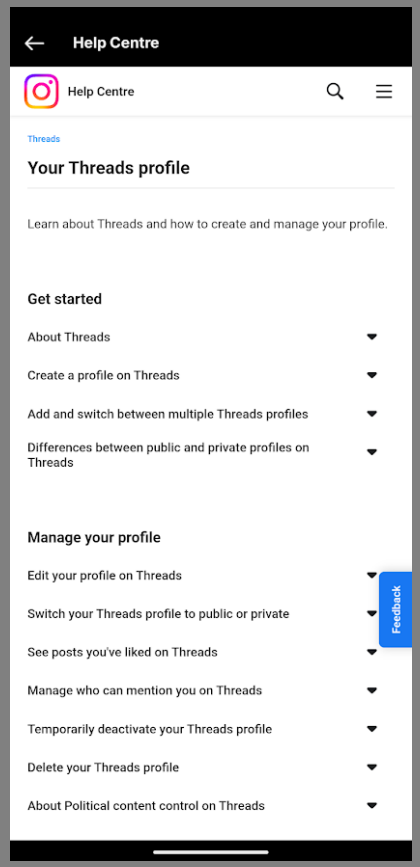
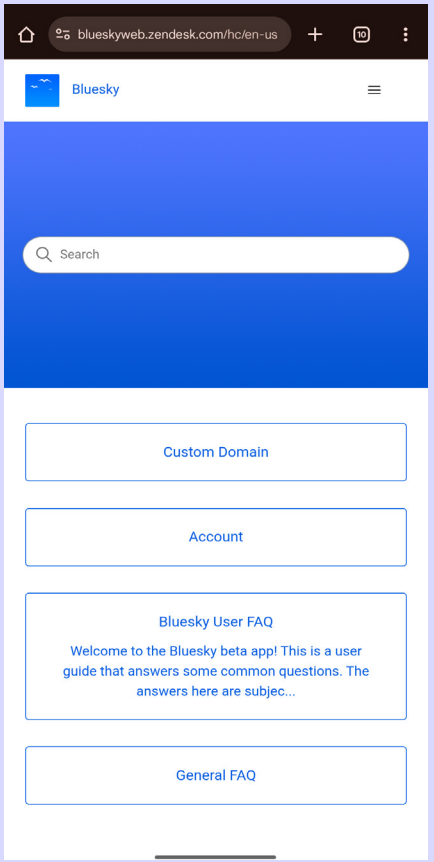
Threads provides clear error prompts (e.g., "Failed to upload" or "Try again") when posts don't load or upload properly.



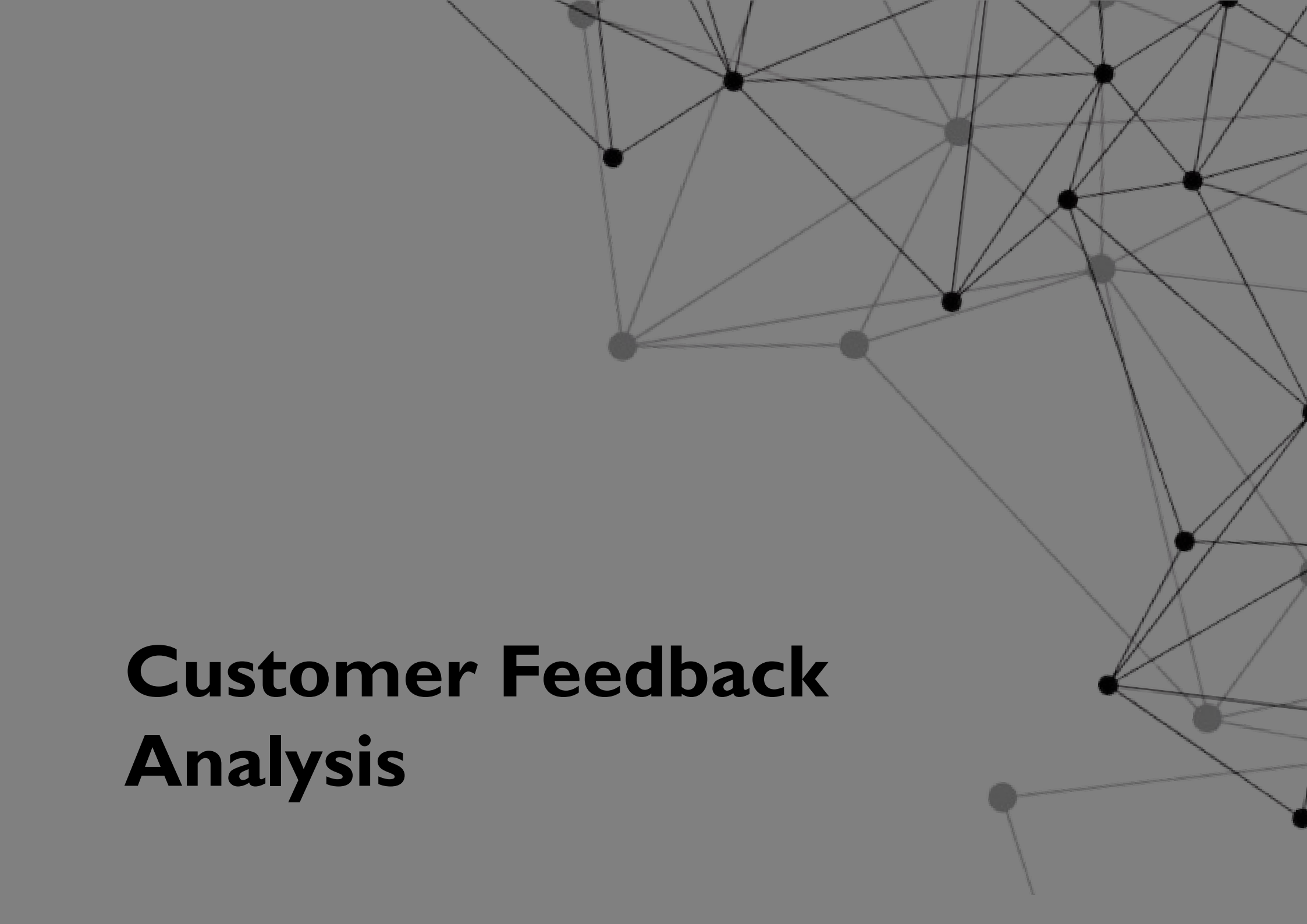
Bluesky shows basic error messages but without much context or guidance for fixing issues.

Law Applied

Help & Documentation

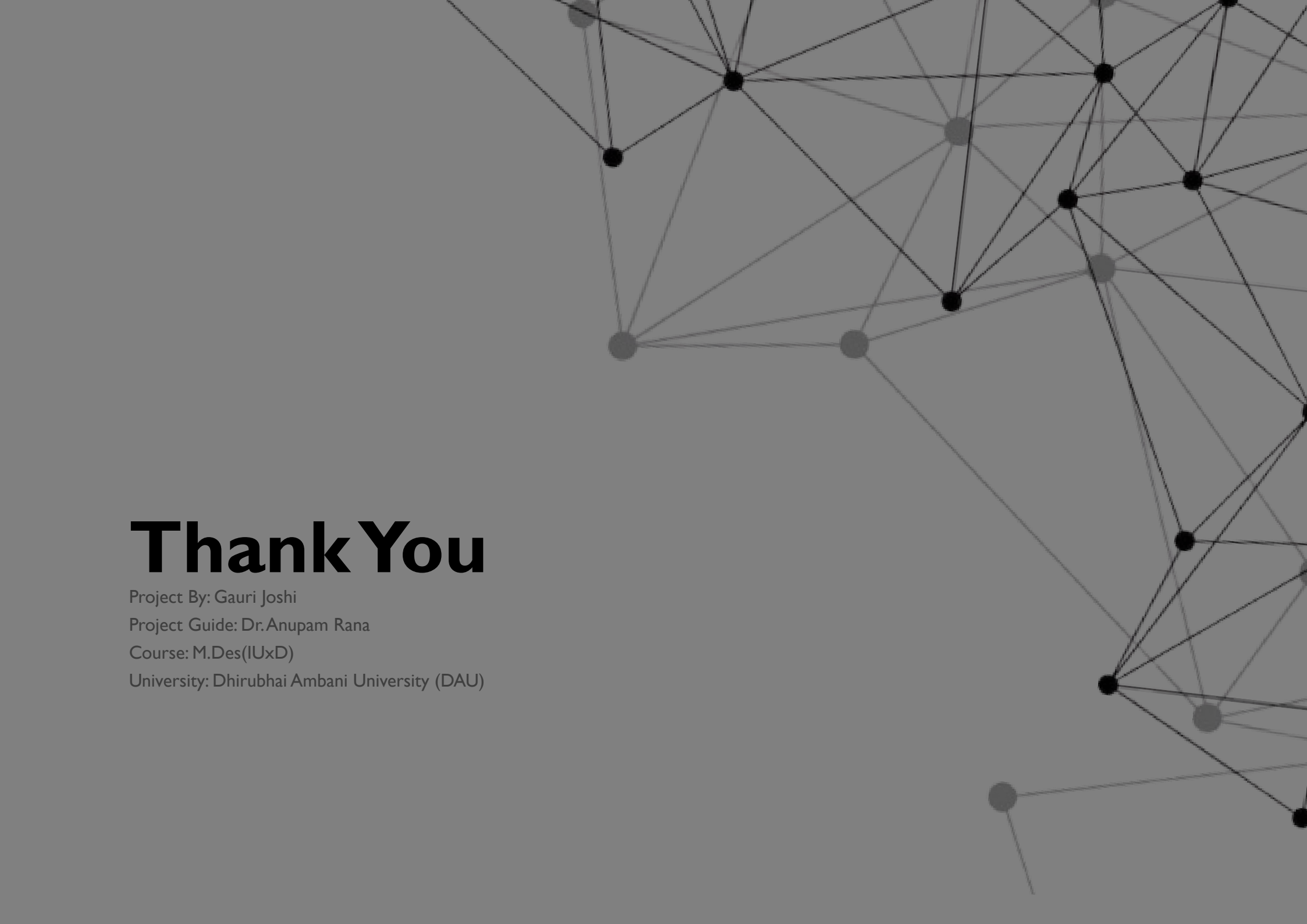
Usability Heuristics: Support		
Even though systems should be easy to use without documentation, users may need accessible help or guidance when required.		
	Threads offers in-app guidance through FAQs and links to Meta Help Center, making troubleshooting easy.	Bluesky has limited help or documentation within the app; users often rely on external community forums for support.
Law Applied	✓	✓

Customer Feedback Analysis



Final Verdict

User's Review	★★★★★ An unsung treasure, this app is great as an artist to let loose and build community in a way that's as engaging as old Tumblr and Twitter. It's definitely more for text posts, but it's really fun to ask questions and get feedback and see other people's art. It's a perfect companion to Insta, and the algorithm really is tailored to the way I use the app. ★★★★★ I've been exploring Threads lately - it's simple, smooth, and feels like a chill corner of social media. Love how easy it is to connect with my Instagram audience and share thoughts that don't need a photo every time. Still new, but definitely growing on me. ★☆☆☆☆ I'll change my review of this app if somebody can explain to me why every single time I leave the app (while it is still active in the background), and then return to it seconds later, my feed refreshes itself all the way back to the top, forcing me to lose the post I was just looking at. This happens MORE than 75% of the time. Extremely frustrating.	★☆☆☆☆ There's problems in the app. The videos are extremely slow to load, or after leaving and returning to the app the videos just wouldn't load at all. The same thing with loading images after leaving the app just a few minutes later. heck, that also affects the rest of the app's function if that happens. I hope you guys see this and don't ignore it. You'll need to hear everything to make the app better. ★★☆☆☆ I like the overall friendly community on there, but unfortunately the constant glitches are what does it for me. Home page just doesn't load, I honestly can't even see anything on there for more than a few secs before it glitches with an "internet connection error" notificagion (btw my internet works fine) and it's growing increasingly difficult to even post images on there, which sucks as I'm an artist. Also, it happens even in browser.
Conclusion	Most users appreciate Threads for its smooth interface, easy connection with Instagram, and simple, clutter-free experience. Minor frustrations like feed refreshing or navigation glitches exist, but overall, users find it reliable and growing in performance.	Users praise Bluesky's concept and community, but frequent loading issues, slow performance, and glitches make the experience inconsistent. The platform is still evolving, leading to mixed user satisfaction.
All Over Rating	★★★★½	★★★½☆



Thank You

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